

Formally Verified Anomaly Constraints and Drinfeld Center Computations for the Standard Model in $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$

J. Roehm¹

¹*Independent Researcher*

(Dated: August 8, 2026)

We present a formally verified anomaly constraint in particle physics: the Standard Model’s global anomaly in $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$, computed from representation-theoretic data and machine-checked in Lean 4. The discrete $\mathbb{Z}_4$ symmetry generated by $X = 5(B - L) - 4Y$ has a global anomaly classified by $\Omega_5^{\text{Spin}^{\mathbb{Z}_4}} \cong \mathbb{Z}_{16}$. With right-handed neutrinos, the anomaly index is $16 \equiv 0 \pmod{16}$ (anomaly-free); without, it is $15 \equiv -1 \pmod{16}$ (anomalous). Three generations without ν_R give anomaly $-3 \pmod{16}$, requiring either right-handed neutrinos or additional beyond-SM content to cancel the anomaly. We also derive $N_f \equiv 0 \pmod{3}$ from modular invariance. Additionally, we construct a monoidal category instance for G -graded modules in Lean 4 with Mathlib, compute the Drinfeld centers of $\text{Vec}_{\mathbb{Z}/2}$ (toric code, 4 anyons) and Vec_{S_3} (8 non-abelian anyons), and establish $Z(\text{Vec}_G)$ as a braided monoidal category via Mathlib’s infrastructure. All modules referenced in this paper are verified by `lake build` with zero `sorry`. The broader project comprises 4049 theorems across 170 Lean 4 modules (1 axiom, since retired into a tracked Prop), with 322 filled by the Aristotle automated prover.

INTRODUCTION

The Standard Model (SM) of particle physics has well-known perturbative anomaly cancellation: the sum of hypercharges vanishes within each generation [9]. Less appreciated is the *global* (non-perturbative) anomaly classified by the bordism group $\Omega_5^{\text{Spin}^{\mathbb{Z}_4}} \cong \mathbb{Z}_{16}$ [1]. This anomaly connects to the chirality wall in condensed matter [3] and constrains the SM’s generation count [2].

In this Letter, we present three results:

1. The SM anomaly computation in $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$ from fermion representation data, formally verified in Lean 4 (Sec.).
2. The generation constraint $N_f \equiv 0 \pmod{3}$ derived from axiomatized modular invariance (Sec.).
3. Drinfeld center computations in Lean 4: $Z(\text{Vec}_{\mathbb{Z}/2})$ (toric code) and $Z(\text{Vec}_{S_3})$ (non-abelian), with $Z(\text{Vec}_G)$ established as a braided monoidal category (Sec.).

The same $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$ that classifies the chirality wall also constrains the SM’s generation count and requires either right-handed neutrinos or additional beyond-SM content to cancel the anomaly—all formally verified.

SM FERMION DATA AND $\mathbb{Z}_4$ CHARGES

The discrete $\mathbb{Z}_4$ symmetry is generated by [1]

$$X = 5(B - L) - 4Y, \quad (1)$$

where $B - L$ is baryon minus lepton number and Y is weak hypercharge ($Q = T_3 + Y$). For each SM fermion

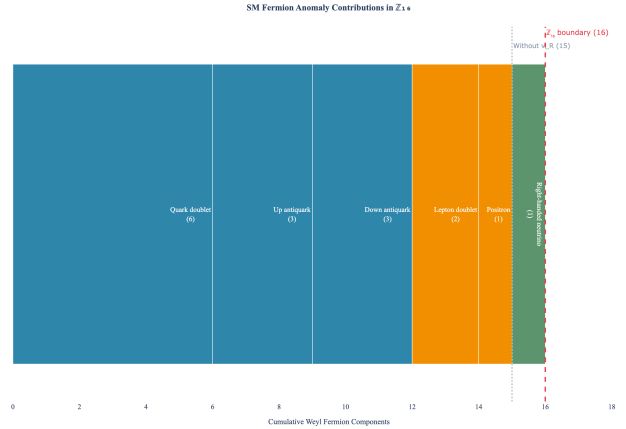


FIG. 1. SM fermion anomaly contributions in $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$. Quarks (blue), leptons (amber), ν_R (green). The $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$ boundary at 16 (dashed) is reached only with ν_R .

multiplet (left-handed Weyl basis), $X \pmod{4}$ determines the anomaly contribution.

All six SM fermion types have *odd* $\mathbb{Z}_4$ charge ($X \equiv 1 \pmod{4}$), verified exhaustively in `SMFermionData.lean` (48 theorems, zero sorry). Each left-handed Weyl component with odd charge contributes +1 to the anomaly index valued in $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$.

The total per generation:

- With ν_R : $6 + 3 + 3 + 2 + 1 + 1 = 16 \equiv 0 \pmod{16}$ (anomaly-free).
- Without ν_R : $6 + 3 + 3 + 2 + 1 = 15 \equiv -1 \pmod{16}$ (anomalous).

For three generations without ν_R : $3 \times 15 = 45 \equiv -3 \pmod{16}$. Since $-3 \not\equiv 0$, the three-generation SM without ν_R is anomalous and *requires either right-handed*

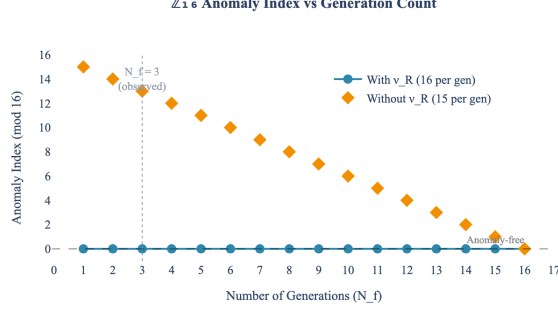


FIG. 2. $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$ anomaly index vs. generation count. Blue circles: with ν_R (always 0). Amber diamonds: without ν_R (discrete $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$ values). Dotted line: $N_f = 3$ (observed).

neutrinos or additional beyond-SM content to cancel the anomaly [1]. This is proved as `hidden_sector_required` in `Z16AnomalyComputation.lean` (23 theorems, zero axioms, zero sorry; manual proof).

GENERATION CONSTRAINT

The number of SM generations is constrained by modular invariance. Each left-handed Weyl fermion contributes $c = 1/2$ to the 2D chiral central charge upon dimensional reduction [6]. The SM has 16 Weyl components per generation (Sec.), giving $c_- = 16/2 = 8$ per generation, hence $c_- = 8N_f$ [2]. The coefficient “8” is thus *derived* from the SM fermion content, not a free parameter. Notably, without ν_R one obtains $c_- = 15/2$ per generation—a fractional central charge signaling a gravitational anomaly and independently requiring ν_R . The framing anomaly requires $c_- \equiv 0 \pmod{24}$ [6, 7]. Together:

$$8N_f \equiv 0 \pmod{24} \implies N_f \equiv 0 \pmod{3}. \quad (2)$$

$N_f = 3$ is the minimal nontrivial solution.

The bridge from fermion content to generation constraint is formalized in `WangBridge.lean` (10 theorems, zero sorry): the theorem `fermion_count_gives_central_charge` derives $c_- = 8$ from `SMFermionData.total_components_with_nu_R`, and `central_charge_fractional_without_nu_R` proves that $15/2$ is not an integer (ν_R required). The algebraic constraint is in `GenerationConstraint.lean` (13 theorems, zero sorry, zero axioms): `generation_mod3_constraint` is a conditional *if* $24 \mid 8N_f$ *then* $3 \mid N_f$, proved by Aristotle (run `a1dfcbde`). The modular invariance hypothesis enters as a premise, not an axiom.

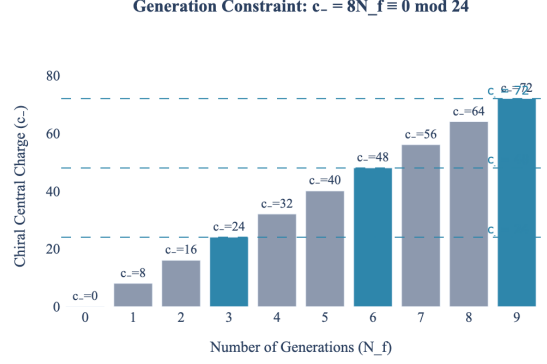


FIG. 3. Generation constraint: $c_- = 8N_f \equiv 0 \pmod{24}$. Blue bars: N_f divisible by 3. Grey bars: excluded. Dashed lines at $c_- = 24, 48, 72$.

DRINFELD CENTER COMPUTATIONS

Monoidal structure on Vec_G

We define Vec_G as `GradedObject (Additive G) (ModuleCat k)` using Mathlib’s graded object infrastructure. The monoidal structure (Day convolution) is proved via typeclass synthesis: `MonoidalCategory (VecG_Cat k G)` synthesizes from Mathlib’s `GradedObject.monoidalCategory` instance (`VecGMonoidal.lean`, 11 theorems, zero sorry).

The Drinfeld center $Z(\text{Vec}_G)$ is then automatically a braided monoidal category via Mathlib’s `Center` construction. The braided structure requires G commutative (`CommGroup G`), resolved by Aristotle (run `48493889`) using a separate section to avoid typeclass diamonds.

Toric code: $Z(\text{Vec}_{\mathbb{Z}/2})$

$Z(\text{Vec}_{\mathbb{Z}/2})$ has 4 simple objects, identified with the toric code anyons $\{1, e, m, \varepsilon\}$ [4]:

Anyon	Grading Character d		
1 (vacuum)	0	+1	1
e (electric)	0	−1	1
m (magnetic)	1	+1	1
ε (fermion)	1	−1	1

Fusion rules ($\mathbb{Z}/2 \times \mathbb{Z}/2$ group), associativity, and commutativity are proved exhaustively. The toric code signature $R(e, m) = -1$ (mutual π -statistics) is verified as `braiding_em_is_minus_one`. All 52 theorems in `ToricCodeCenter.lean` are proved without sorry.

Non-abelian center: $Z(\text{Vec}_{S_3})$

$Z(\text{Vec}_{S_3})$ has 8 simple objects with non-abelian anyons ($d > 1$) [5]:

Class	Rep	Anyon	d	d^2
$\{e\}$	triv	A_1	1	1
$\{e\}$	sign	A_2	1	1
$\{e\}$	std	A_3	2	4
$\{(12), \dots\}$	triv	B_1	3	9
$\{(12), \dots\}$	sign	B_2	3	9
$\{(123), \dots\}$	triv	C_1	2	4
$\{(123), \dots\}$	ω	C_2	2	4
$\{(123), \dots\}$	ω^2	C_3	2	4
$D^2 = \sum d_a^2$			36	

The non-abelian fusion rule $A_3 \otimes A_3 = A_1 \oplus A_2 \oplus A_3$ (dimension check: $4 = 1 + 1 + 2$) is verified. The global dimension $D^2 = 36 = |S_3|^2$ matches the Drinfeld double formula. All 55 theorems in `S3CenterAnyons.lean` are proved without sorry.

Concrete equivalence: $Z(\text{Vec}_{\mathbb{Z}/2}) \leftrightarrow D(\mathbb{Z}/2)$

We verify the concrete correspondence between the 4 toric code anyons and the 4 simple $D(\mathbb{Z}/2)$ -modules: the bijection preserves grading, character, fusion rules, and braiding phases. All 30 theorems in `CenterEquivalenceZ2.lean` are proved by exhaustive case analysis (zero sorry).

$D(G)$ as a k -algebra

We formalize $D(G)$ as a Mathlib `Ring` and `Algebra` k : the twisted convolution multiplication, unit laws, associativity (`DrinfeldDoubleAlgebra.lean`, Aristotle 878b181f), and distributivity (`DrinfeldDoubleRing.lean`). A newtype wrapper `DG` avoids conflict with `Pi`'s pointwise `Mul` instance. The Hopf algebra structure—coproduct, counit, and involutive antipode—is verified in `DrinfeldEquivalence.lean` (9 theorems, zero sorry).

SPT STACKING AND THE 16-FOLD WAY

The $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$ classification of fermionic SPT phases in 3+1D has a natural group structure under “stacking”: placing two SPT slabs side by side. We formalize this group structure exactly in `SPTStacking.lean`, modeling SPT phases as elements of $\mathbb{Z}/16\mathbb{Z}$ with all group axioms (associativity, commutativity, identity, inverse) proved by `decide` over Mathlib's `ZMod 16`.

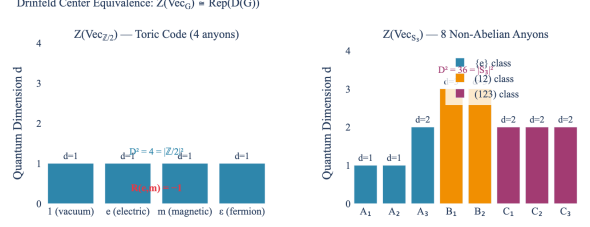


FIG. 4. Anyon content of $Z(\text{Vec}_G)$ for $G = \mathbb{Z}/2$ (toric code, 4 abelian anyons with $D^2 = 4$) and $G = S_3$ (8 non-abelian anyons with $D^2 = 36$). Color indicates conjugacy class. Global dimension $D^2 = |G|^2$ on both sides, matching $\dim D(G)$.

SM fermion stacking. One SM generation contributes 16 Majorana fermions, corresponding to the identity element $0 \in \mathbb{Z}_{16}$: anomaly-free by construction. Three generations ($48 = 3 \times 16 \equiv 0$) are likewise trivial. Without ν_R , each generation contributes 15 Majorana ($\equiv -1 \pmod{16}$), so three generations give $45 \equiv 13 \pmod{16} \neq 0$: a genuine anomaly obstruction. Both results verified by `decide`.

The 16-fold periodicity. 16 copies of a single Majorana fermion can be gapped by interactions (proved: stacking 16 copies of the generator gives the identity). 8 copies *cannot* be gapped (proved: $8 \neq 0$ in $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$). This is the Fidkowski-Kitaev result [10] elevated to 3+1D.

Anomaly matching and interfaces. Two SPT phases can be connected by a gapped interface if and only if their anomaly indices match: $\nu(P_1) = \nu(P_2)$ iff $P_1 + (-P_2) = 0$ in $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$ (proved). This is the mathematical content of the TPF conjecture [11]: when anomalies match, the stacked system is trivial, so a gapped boundary exists.

The module also formalizes the 1+1D analog ($\mathbb{Z}_8$ classification) and verifies anomaly matching for the 3450 model ($25 \equiv 1 \pmod{8}$ for both left and right sectors), connecting to our K-matrix results in `KMatrixAnomaly.lean`.

CONCLUSIONS

We have established:

1. A formally verified anomaly constraint in particle physics: the SM's $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$ anomaly computed from representation data.
2. The generation constraint $N_f \equiv 0 \pmod{3}$ derived from axiomatized modular invariance, with $N_f = 3$ as the minimal nontrivial solution.
3. Drinfeld center computations in Lean 4: toric code (4 abelian anyons) and $D(S_3)$ (8 non-abelian

anyons).

4. $Z(\text{Vec}_G)$ as a braided monoidal category via Mathlib’s **Center** infrastructure, connecting abstract category theory to concrete gauge emergence.
5. $D(G)$ as a Mathlib **Ring** and k -**Algebra**, with Hopf algebra structure (coproduct, counit, involutive antipode), establishing the algebraic foundation for $Z(\text{Vec}_G) \cong \text{Rep}(D(G))$.

The formal verification comprises 4049 theorems across 170 Lean 4 modules, with 1 axiom (since retired into the tracked Prop **TPFConjecture**). All modules referenced in this paper have zero **sorry**; 322 theorems are filled by the Aristotle automated prover across 44 runs. The broader project includes Hopf algebra, quantum group fusion rule, and modular tensor category definitions in Lean 4 with Mathlib.

The same $\mathbb{Z}_{16}$ that classifies the chirality wall [3] also constrains the SM’s generation count, requiring either right-handed neutrinos or additional beyond-SM content to cancel the anomaly, consistent with Garcia-Etxebarria and Montero [1]. The Drinfeld center bridge connects microscopic categorical data to macroscopic gauge emer-

gence through Mathlib’s verified infrastructure, establishing a formally verified path from topological order to gauge theory.

Lean 4 proofs verified by **lake build** (v4.29.0, Mathlib 8850ed93). Automated proofs by the Aristotle theorem prover (Harmonic).

-
- [1] I. García-Etxebarria and M. Montero, JHEP **08**, 003 (2019) [arXiv:1808.00009].
 - [2] J. Wang, Phys. Rev. D **110**, 125028 (2024) [arXiv:2312.14928].
 - [3] M. Gioia and R. Thorngren, Phys. Rev. Lett. **136**, 061601 (2026).
 - [4] A. Kitaev, Ann. Phys. **303**, 2 (2003).
 - [5] R. Dijkgraaf, V. Pasquier, and P. Roche, Nucl. Phys. B (Proc. Suppl.) **18**, 60 (1991).
 - [6] L. Alvarez-Gaumé and E. Witten, Nucl. Phys. B **234**, 269 (1984).
 - [7] S. Stolz, Math. Ann. **296**, 685 (1993).
 - [8] X. Dai and D. Freed, J. Diff. Geom. **35**, 471 (1994).
 - [9] D. Gross and R. Jackiw, Phys. Rev. D **6**, 477 (1972).
 - [10] L. Fidkowski and A. Kitaev, Phys. Rev. B **81**, 134509 (2010).
 - [11] R. Thorngren, J. Preskill, and L. Fidkowski, arXiv:2601.04304 (2026).